

**28. a. Singly Linked List – TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive**  
**–Program Analysis and Time Complexity .**

**Program: –**

```
void TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(Node **head)
{
    if (*head == nullptr)
    {
        cout << "List is empty." << endl;
        return;
    }
    else
    {
        if ((*head)->next != nullptr)
        {
            TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&((*head)->next));
        }
        cout << (*head)->data << " ";
    }
}

....
case 26:
{
    cout << endl;
    cout << endl;
    cout << "Traverse List Reverse Order Recursive" << endl;
    TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&head);
    cout << endl;
    cout << endl;
    break;
}
```

### 1) Linked List is Empty:

*Pictorially depicted as:*

**Node \* head**

**Address**

**Head**

*ff21*

**nullptr**

```
if (*head == nullptr)
{
    cout << "List is empty." << endl;
    return;
}
```

*TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive(&head: ff21);*

```
void TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive (Node **head) {...}
```

**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**

**(Node \*\* head):**

**Address**

**Head**

*ff29*

*ff21*

**Node \* head**

**Address**

**Head**

*ff21*

**nullptr**

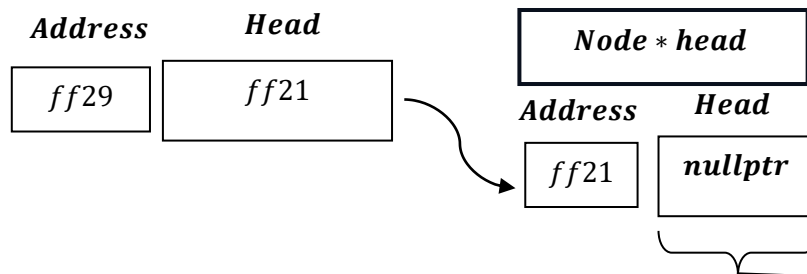
*if(\* head == nullptr) if it is true*

*If true then Why true ?*

*Ans: Though \* head which is of Node \*\* head temporary pointer to pointer variable of the function , as \* head is used , it dereference from Node \*\* head and refer to Node \* head global pointer to which Node \*\* head is pointing to and then its value is checked is whether equal to nullptr or not ? This occurs during execution and compilation of the `TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive` function.*

**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**

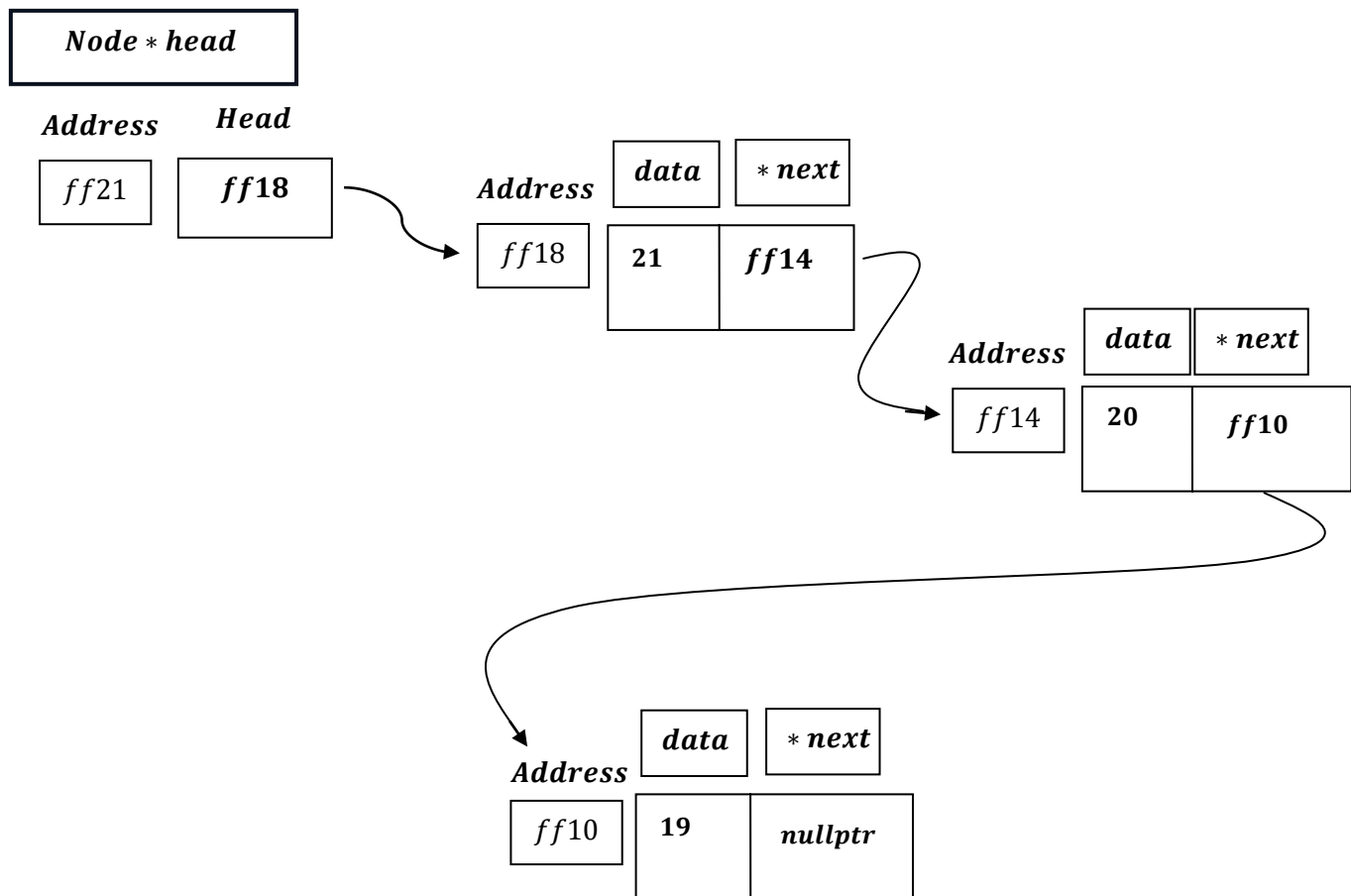
**(Node \*\* head):**



*If List is Empty , then , it prints a message : `Error: List is empty.` and returns nothing as function has void data type .And function ends.*

---

2) Linked List is not Empty:

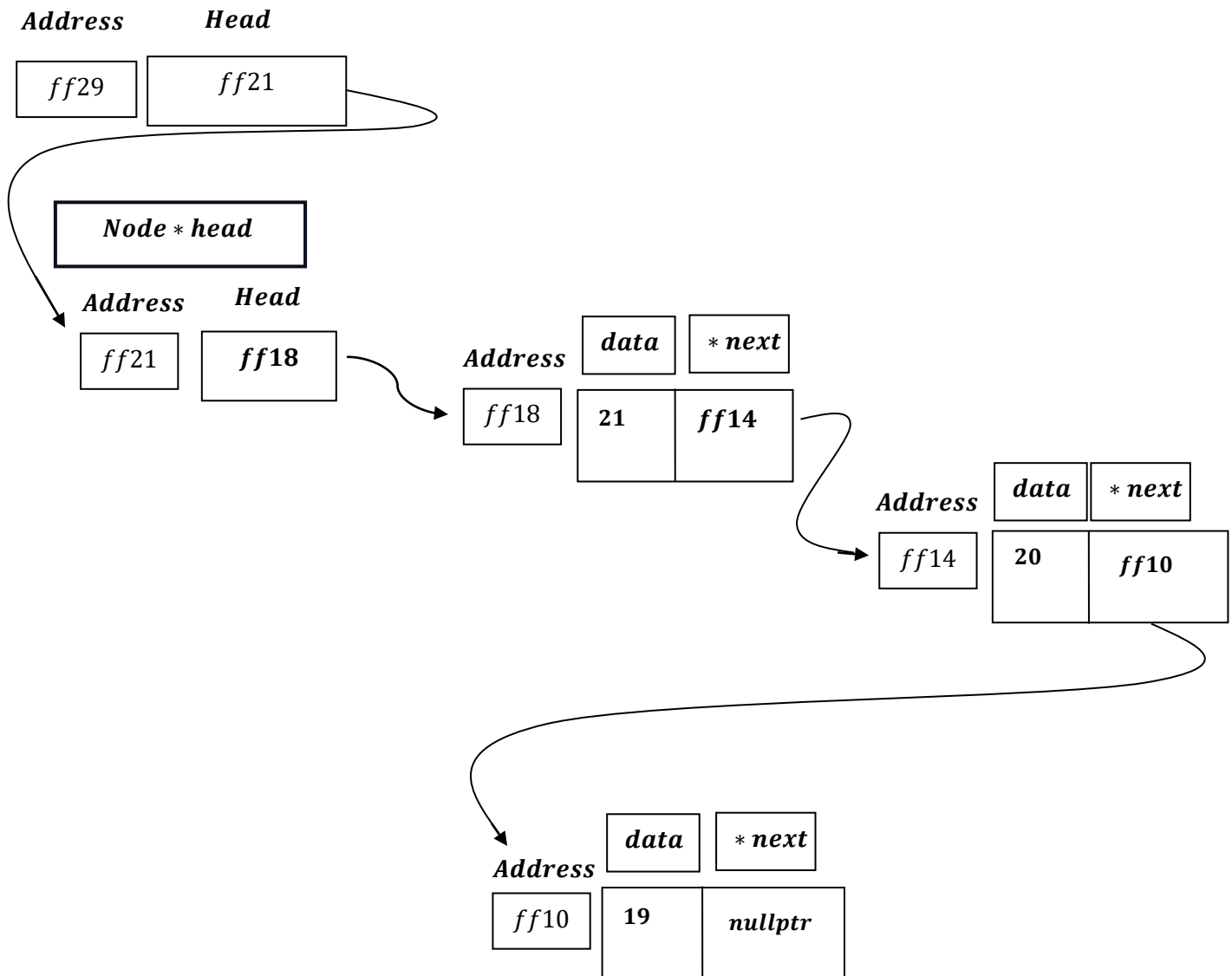


Function Call:

```
TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&head);
```

*i. e. TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive(&head: ff21)*

**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**  
(Node \*\*head):



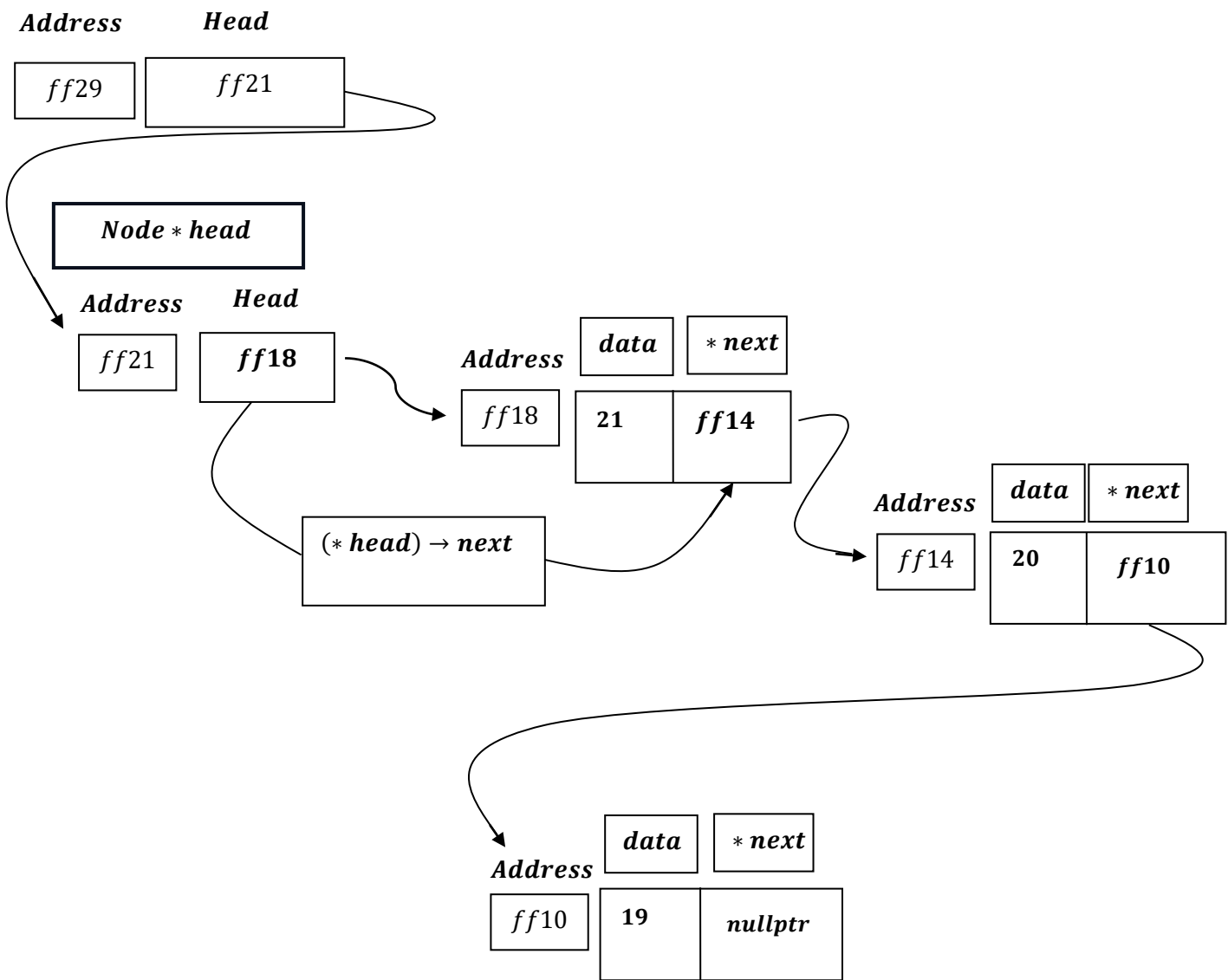
```
void TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(Node **head) {  
    if (*head == nullptr){ ...}  
  
    else  
    {
```

```
if ((*head)->next != nullptr)
{
    TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&((*head)->next));
}
cout << (*head)->data << " ";
}
```

```
if ((*head)->next != nullptr) {...}
```

i.e.,

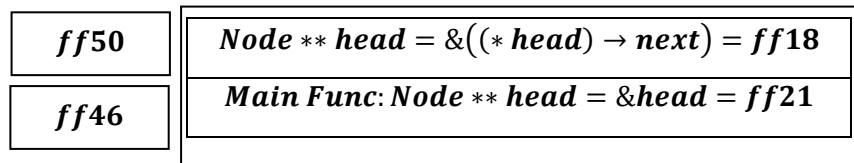
**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**  
(Node \*\* head):



*Node \* head has value i.e. Address  $\rightarrow$  ff18 and ff18  $\rightarrow$  next is ff14 i.e. not nullptr, then:*

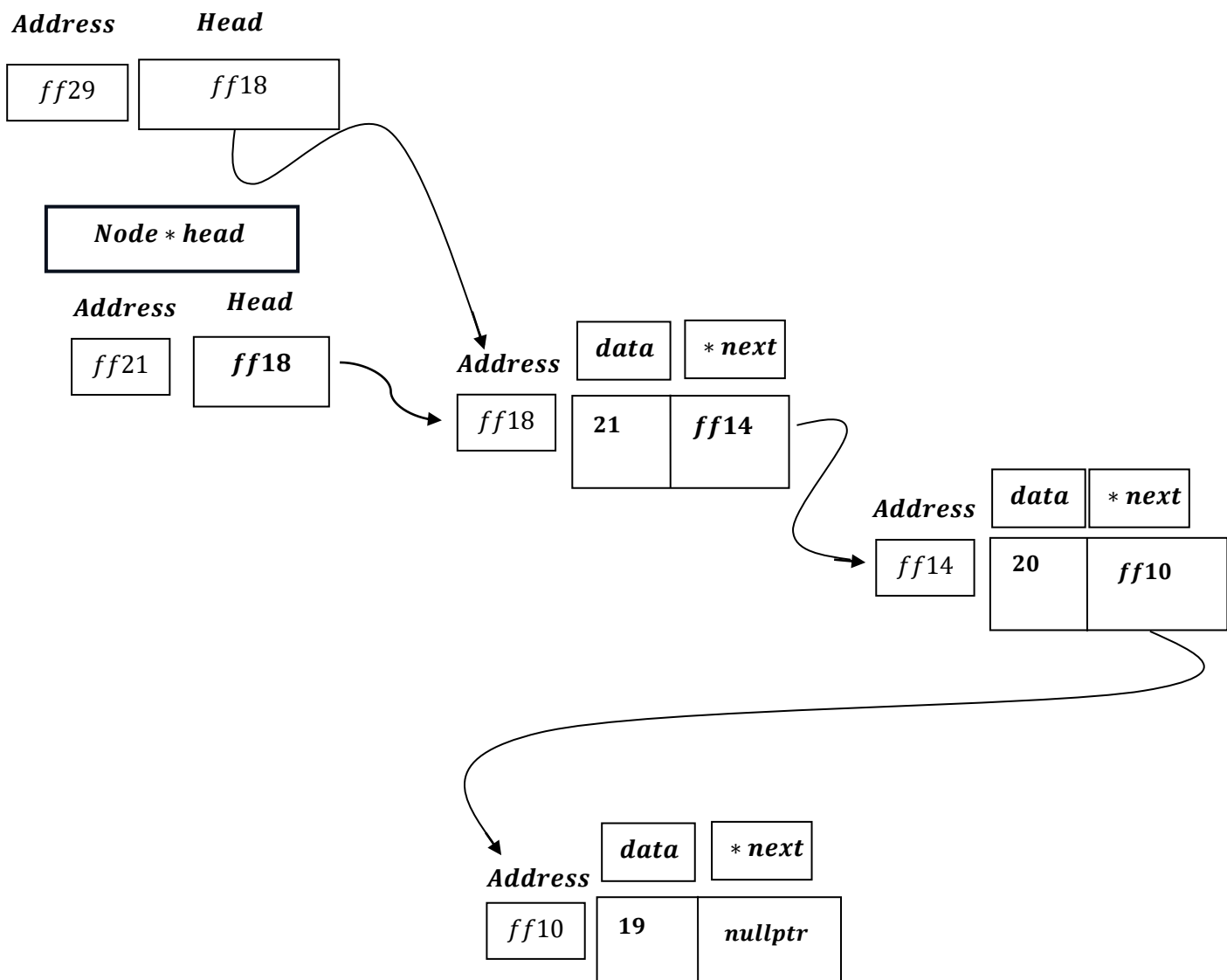
*Recursive Function call:*

```
TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&((*head)->next));
```



*i.e. in Stack it will store the address where  $(\text{* head}) \rightarrow \text{next}; \rightarrow \text{ff14}$  is stored and  $\text{Node ** head} = \&((\text{* head}) \rightarrow \text{next}) = \&(\text{ff14}) = \text{ff18}$ .*

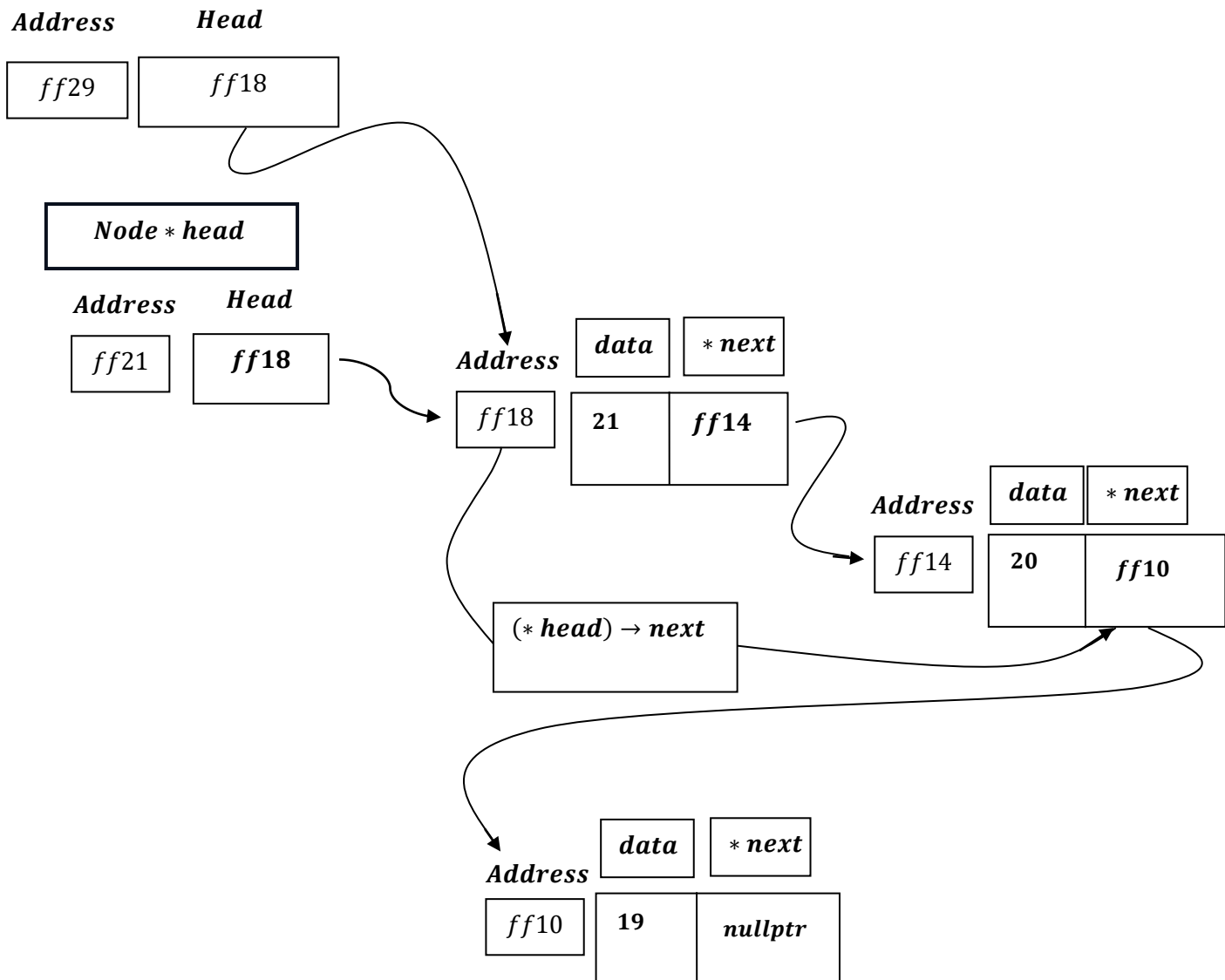
**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**  
(Node \*\* head):



```
if ((*head)->next != nullptr) {...}
```

*i.e.,*

**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**  
(Node \*\* head):



*Note, now, Node \*\* Head doesnot point to Node \* Head , therefore , now ,  
(\* head) will dereference from address ff18 done by dereference operator  
`` \* `` and Node \* will point to ff14 and (\* head) → next; reflects ff14 → next  
i.e., ff10 which is not nullptr , hence again recursive call takes place.*



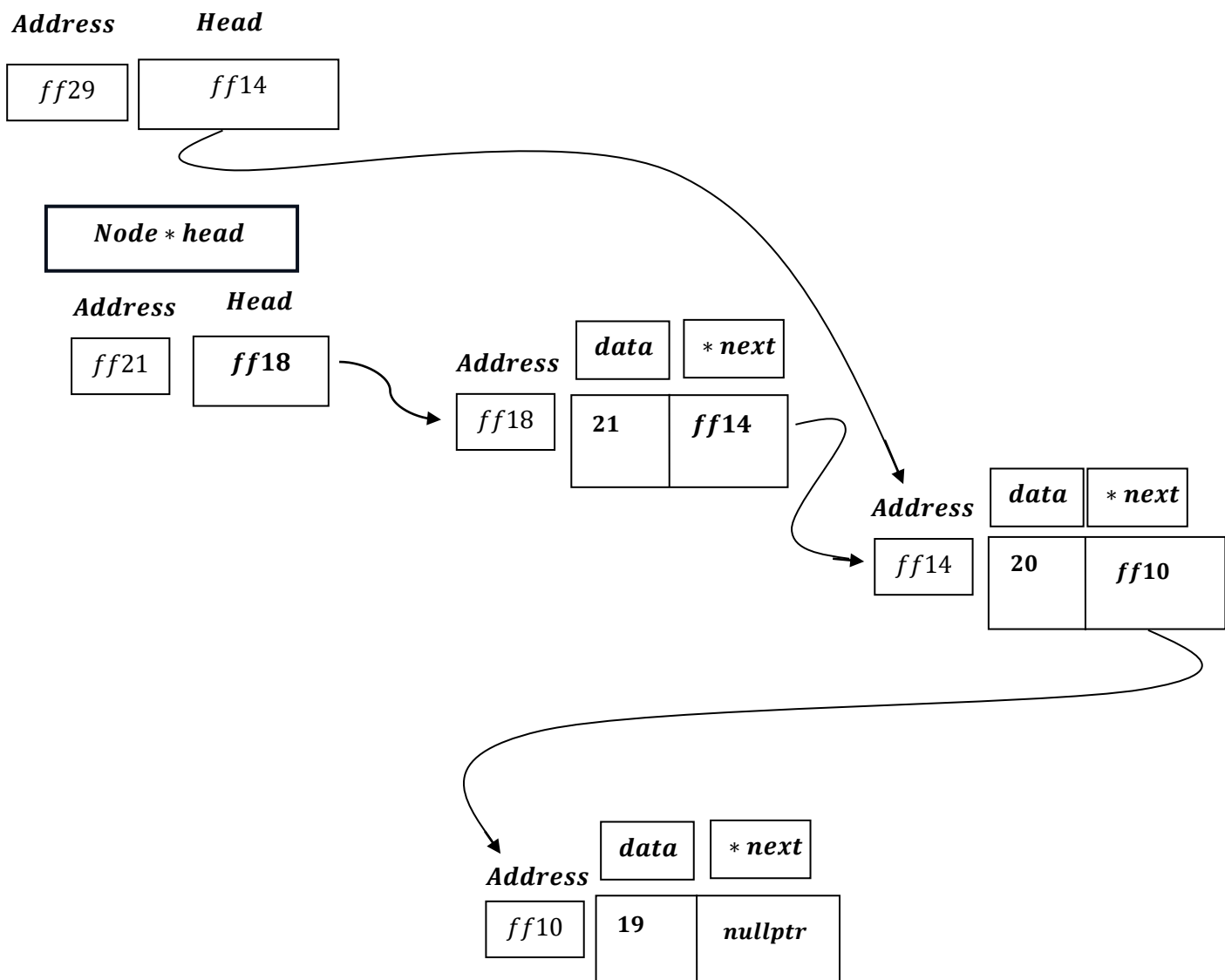
### Recursive Function call:

```
TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&((*head)->next));
```

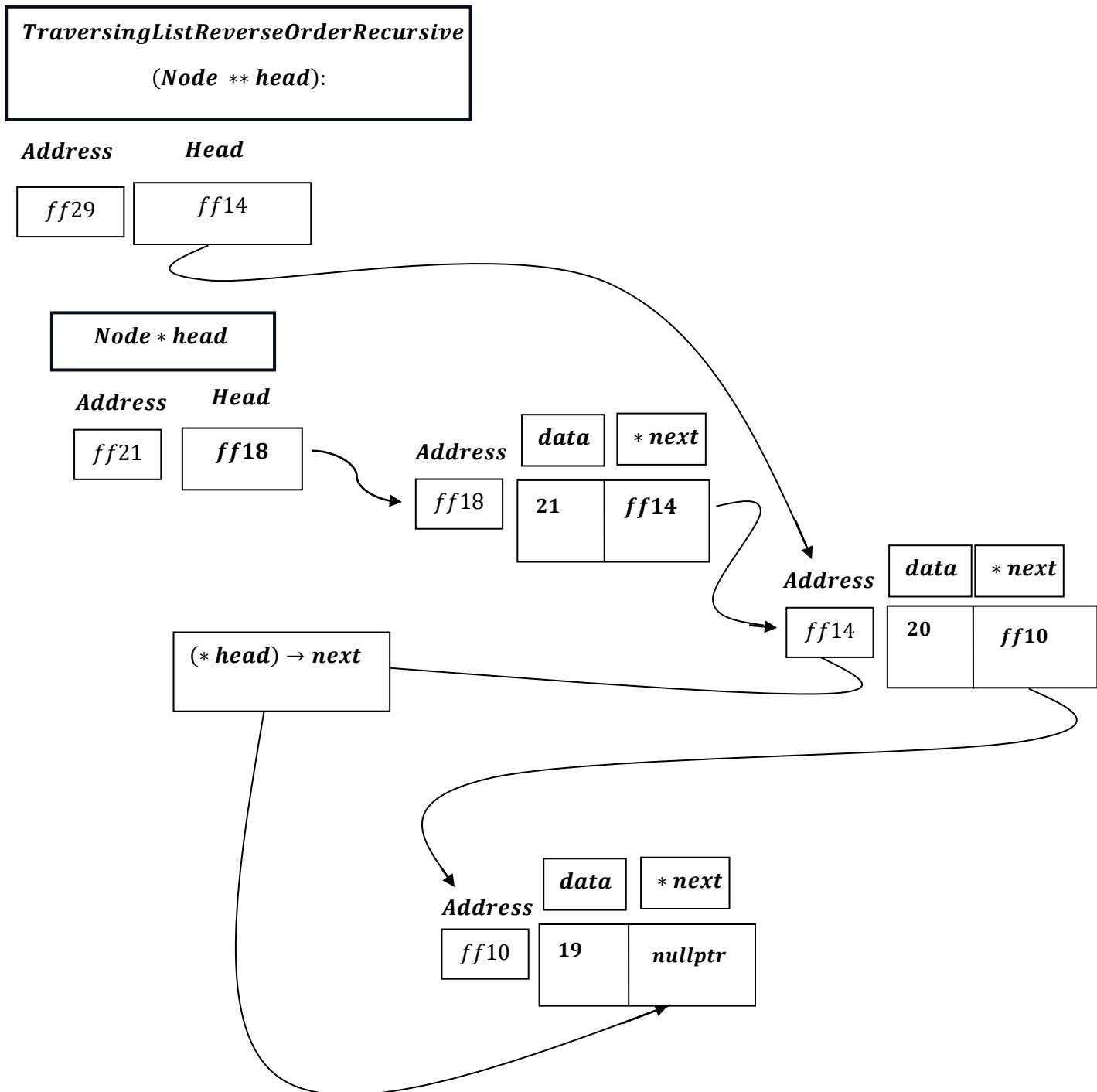
|             |                                                            |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ff54</b> | <b><i>Node ** head = &amp;((* head) → next) = ff14</i></b> |
| <b>ff50</b> | <b><i>Node ** head = &amp;((* head) → next) = ff18</i></b> |
| <b>ff46</b> | <b><i>Main Func: Node ** head = &amp;head = ff21</i></b>   |

i. e. in Stack it will store the address where  $(* head) \rightarrow next; \rightarrow ff10$  is stored and  
 $Node ** head = \&((* head) \rightarrow next) = \&(ff10) = ff14$ .

**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**  
 (Node \*\* head):



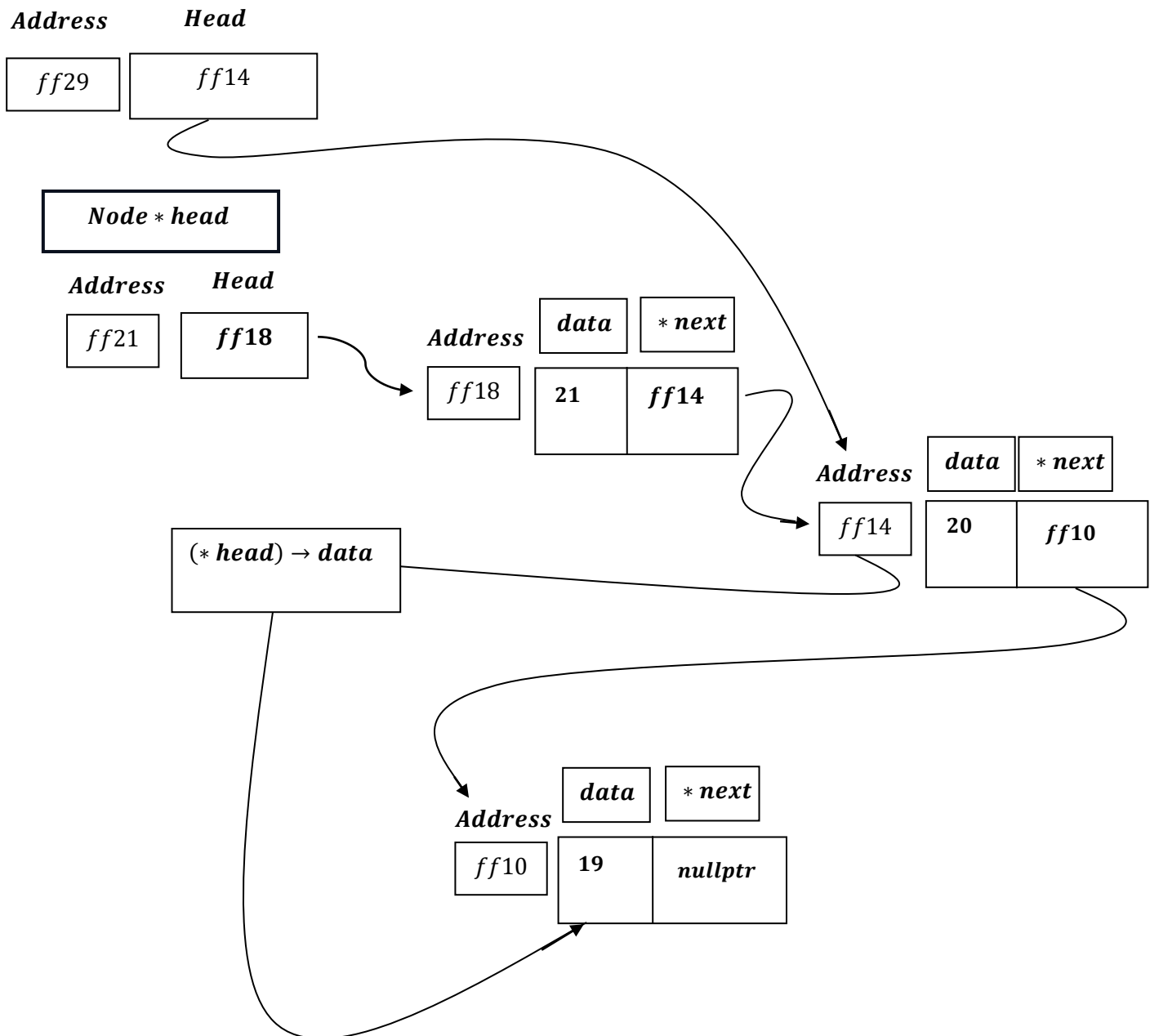
*Note, now, Node \*\* Head doesnt point to Node \* Head , therefore , now ,  
 (\* head) will dereference from address ff14 done by dereference operator  
 `` \* `` and Node \* will point to ff10 and (\* head) → next; reflects ff14 → next  
 i. e., ``nullptr`` which is nullptr , hence again recursive will stop here and exit.*



*Now, we will print (\*head) → data;*

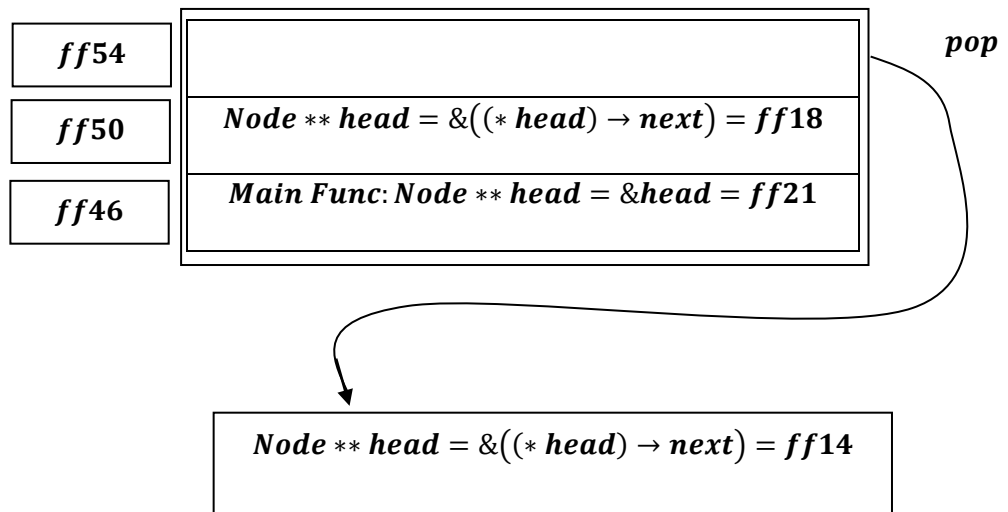
### TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive

**(Node \*\* head):**



Hence (\*head) → data; will print 19.

*Next,  $\text{Node ** head} = \&((\text{* head}) \rightarrow \text{next}) = \text{ff14}$ , will pop out from the stack .*



*Now, in the stack it remains,  $\text{Node ** head} = \text{ff18}$ , hence  $\text{Node ** head}$  will get assigned to *ff18*.*

*i. e.*

***TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive***  
***(Node \*\* head):***

***Address***      ***Head***  

|             |             |
|-------------|-------------|
| <i>ff29</i> | <i>ff18</i> |
|-------------|-------------|

***Node \* head***

***Address***      ***Head***  

|             |             |
|-------------|-------------|
| <i>ff21</i> | <i>ff18</i> |
|-------------|-------------|

***Address***      ***data***      ***\* next***  

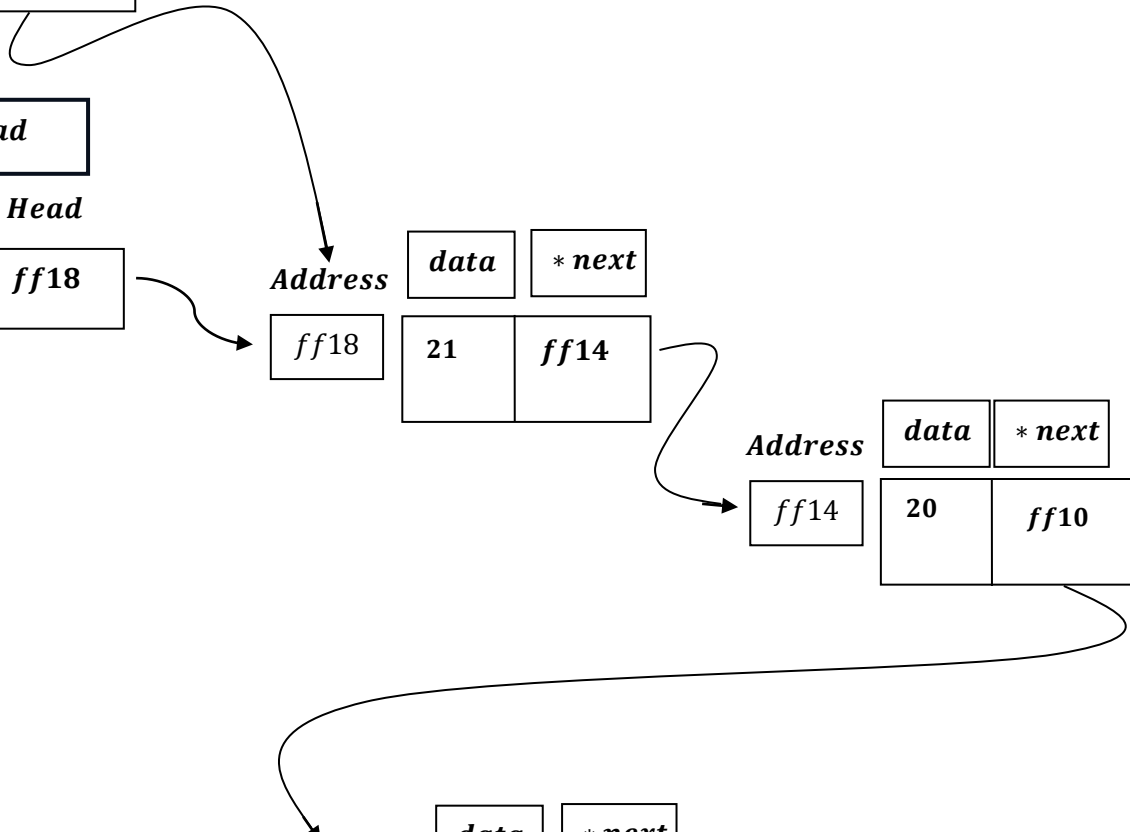
|             |    |             |
|-------------|----|-------------|
| <i>ff18</i> | 21 | <i>ff14</i> |
|-------------|----|-------------|

***Address***      ***data***      ***\* next***  

|             |    |             |
|-------------|----|-------------|
| <i>ff14</i> | 20 | <i>ff10</i> |
|-------------|----|-------------|

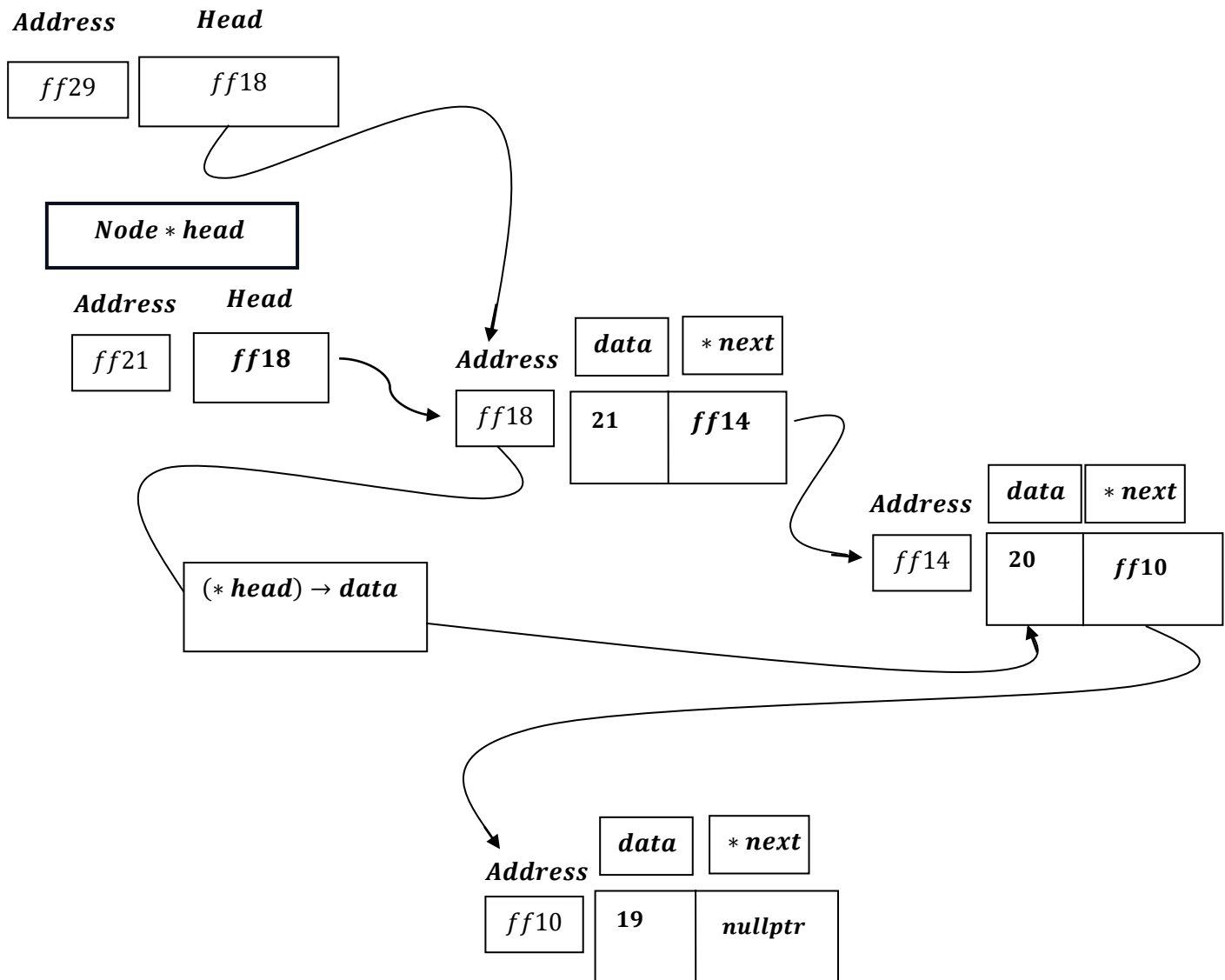
***Address***      ***data***      ***\* next***  

|             |    |                |
|-------------|----|----------------|
| <i>ff10</i> | 19 | <i>nullptr</i> |
|-------------|----|----------------|



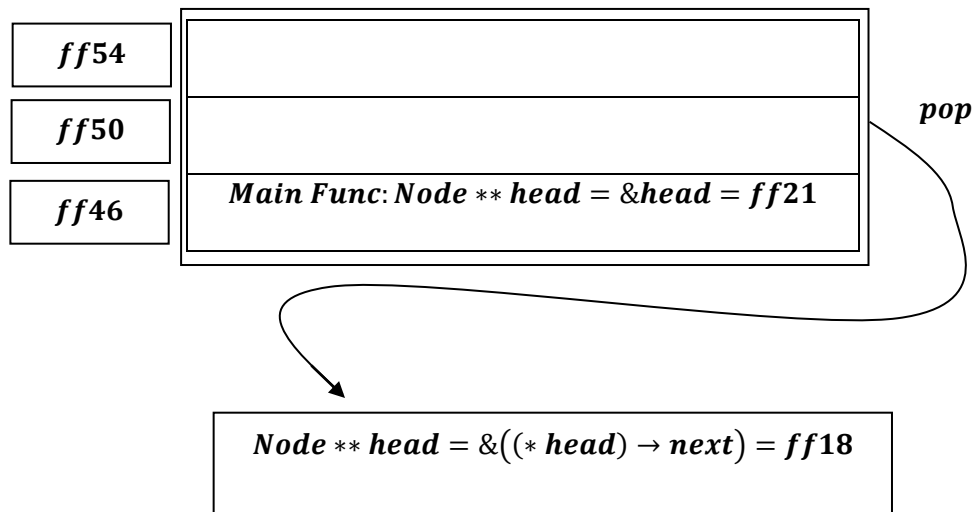
Now, we will print  $(* head) \rightarrow data$ ;

**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**  
(Node \*\* head):



Hence  $(* head) \rightarrow data$ ; will print 20.

*Next,  $\text{Node ** head} = \&((\text{* head}) \rightarrow \text{next}) = \text{ff14}$ , will pop out from the stack .*

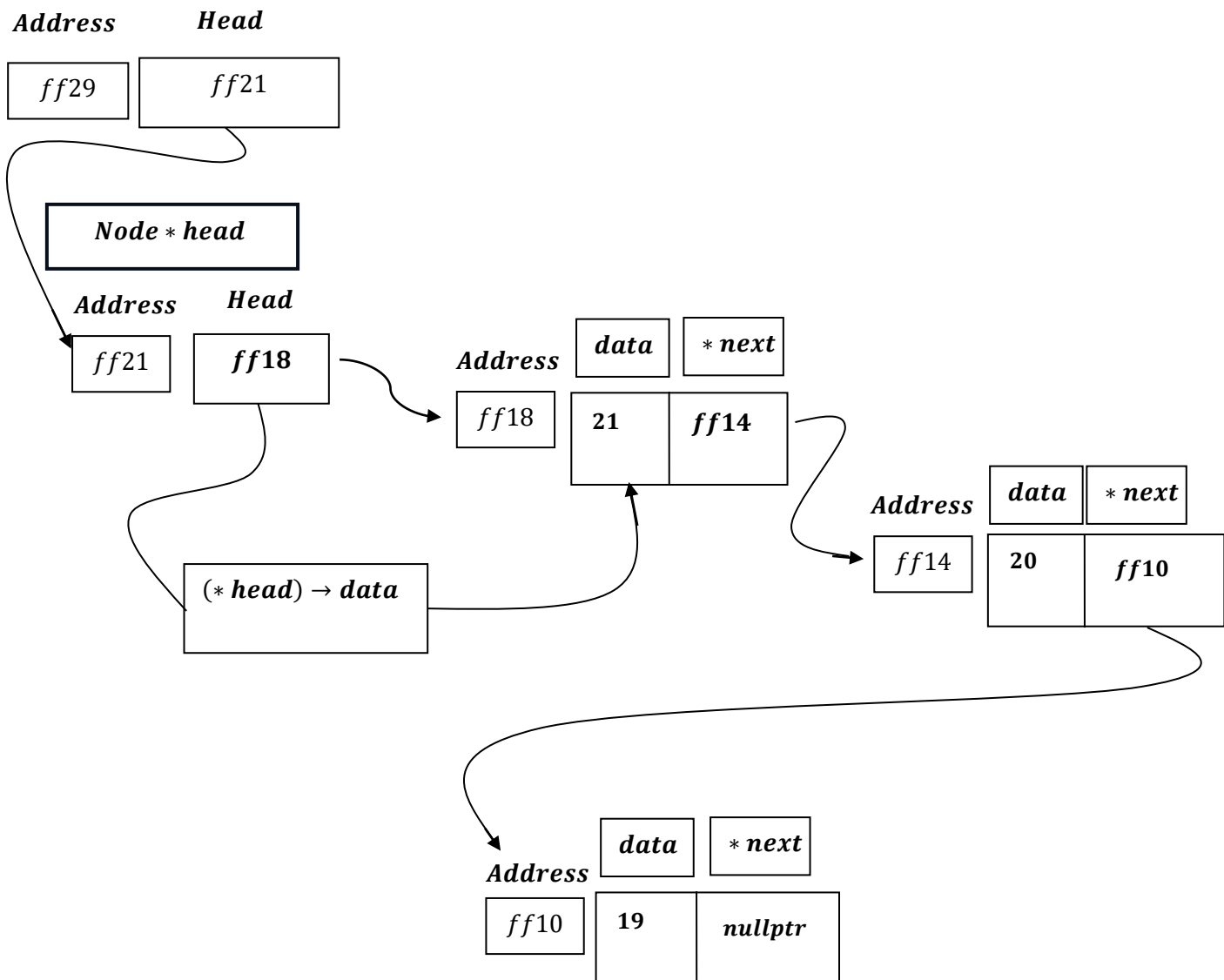


*Now, in the stack it remains,  $\text{Node ** head} = \text{ff21}$ , hence  $\text{Node ** head}$  will get assigned to **ff21**.*

*i. e.*

Now, we will print  $(*head) \rightarrow data$ ;

**TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive**  
**(Node \*\* head):**



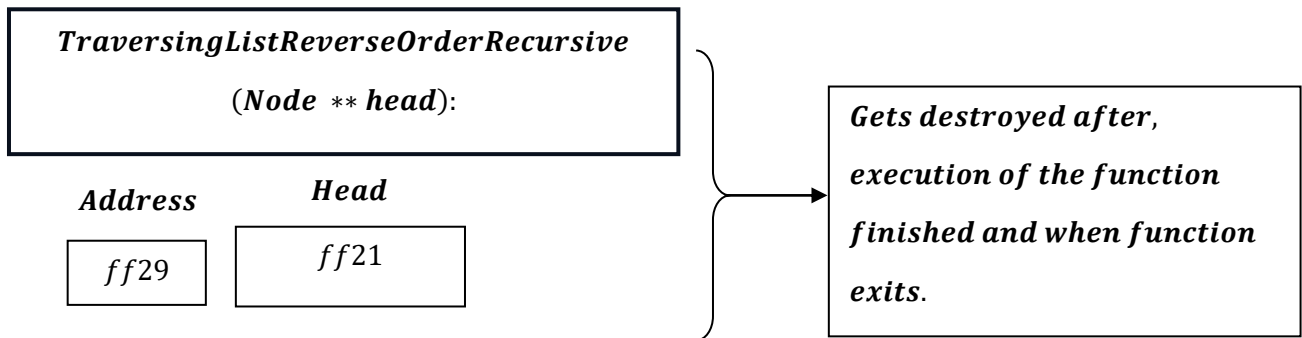
As `Node ** head = &head` i.e address of `Node * head = ff21`, now hence,

$(*head) \rightarrow data$ , here, `* head` reflects `Node * head` i.e. `ff18` and  $(*head) \rightarrow data$  is: `ff18 → data`.

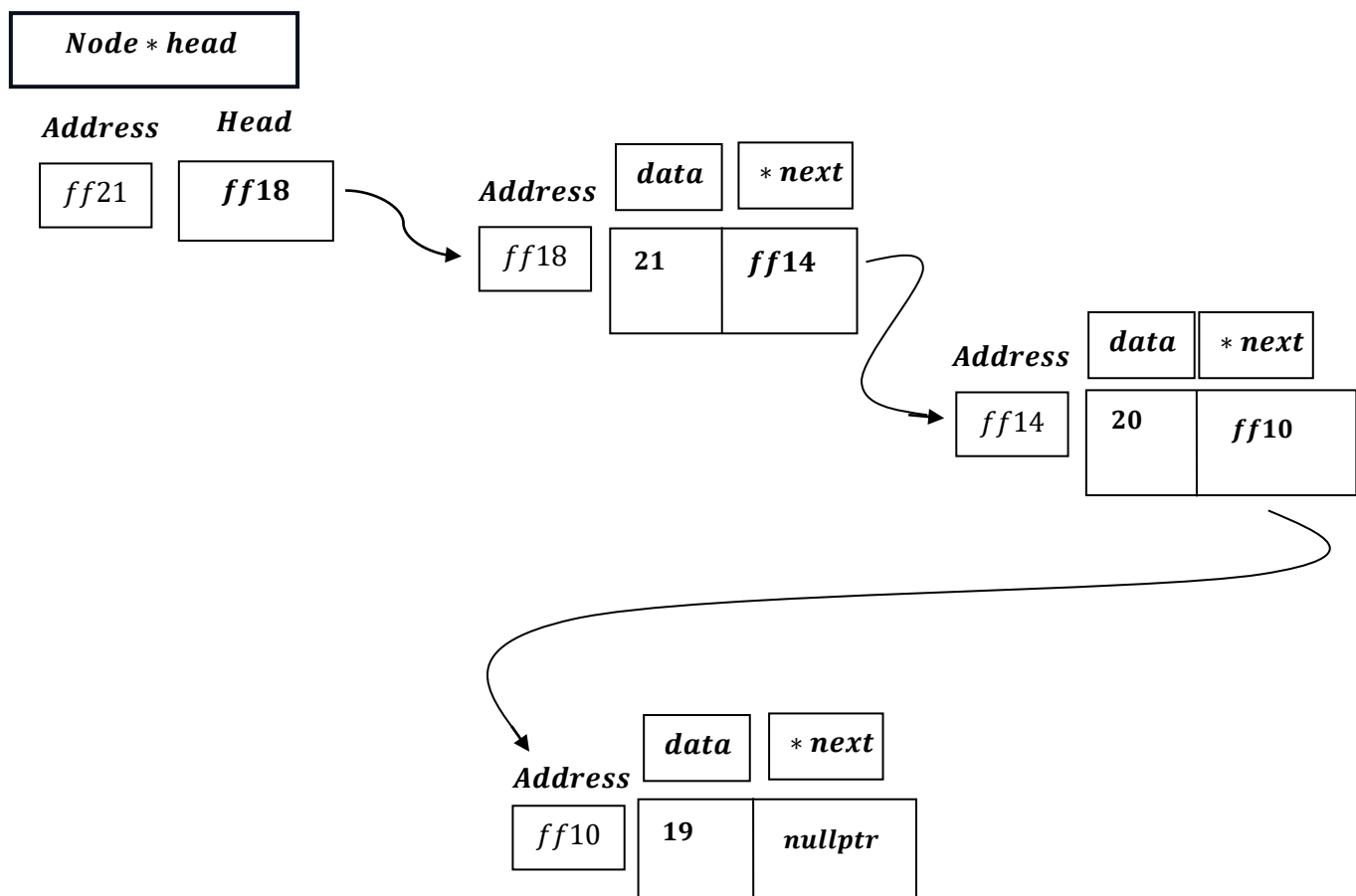
Hence  $(*head) \rightarrow data$ ; will print 21.



*Now, as the function get finished, all temporary variable created earlier in process for the program will get destroyed.*



*And we are left with:*



## ***The function TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive step by step analysis:***

### **1. Function Signature: –**

- ***Parameter: Node \*\* head – a pointer to a pointer to the head of the list. This double pointer is used to maintain a reference to the original head node of the list throughout the recursive calls.***

### **2. Base Case Check for Empty List: –**

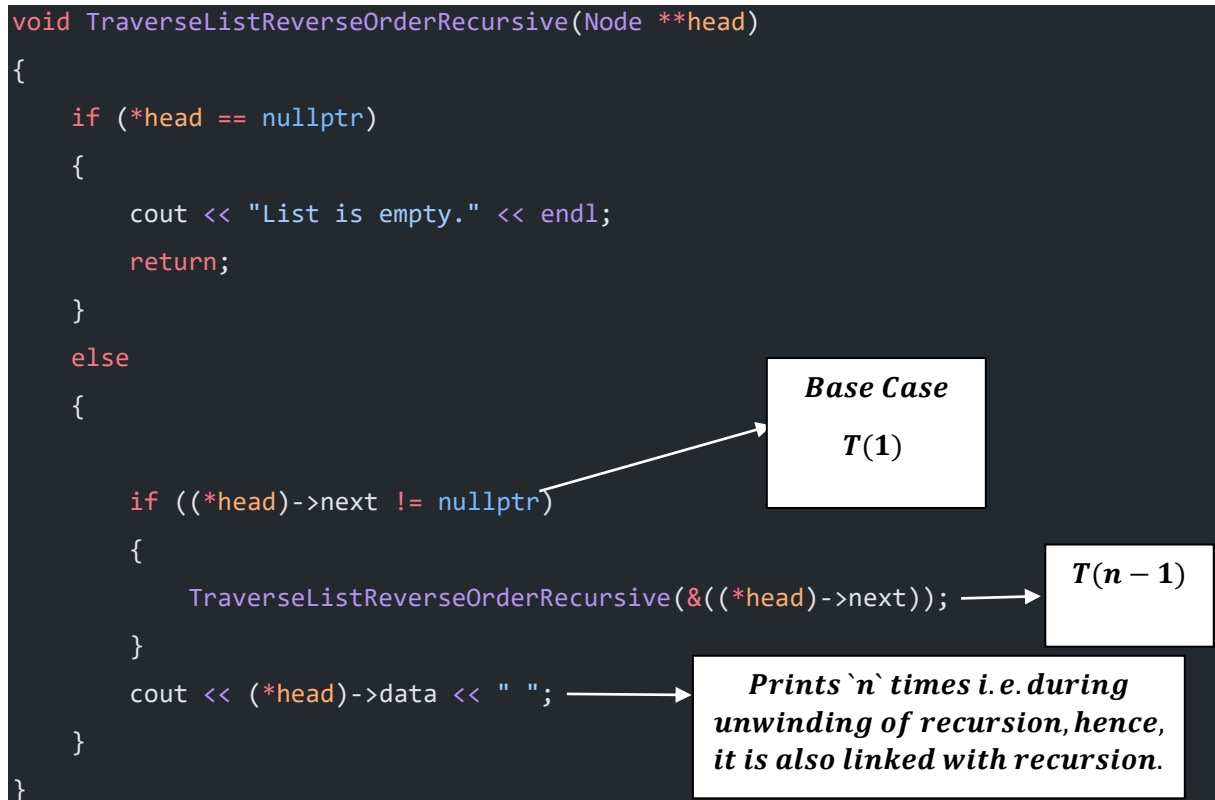
- ***This checks if the list is empty by verifying if the head pointer points to nullptr.***
- ***If the list is empty, it prints "List is empty." and exits the function.***

### **3. Recursive Case:**

- ***Condition: if  $((*head) \rightarrow next \neq nullptr)$ :***
    - ***This checks if the current node (\* head) is not the last node in the list. If it's not the last node, the function makes a recursive call.***
  - ***Recursive Call: TraversalListReverseOrderRecursive( $\&((*head) \rightarrow next)$ ):***
    - ***The function is called recursively with the address of the next pointer of the current node. This moves the recursion one step further along the list.***
    - ***This recursive call continues until the end of the list is reached (i.e., when  $(*head) \rightarrow next$  is nullptr).***
  - ***Print Statement: cout << (\* head) → data << ;***
    - ***After the recursive call returns (which happens when the end of the list is reached and the recursion unwinds), the data of the current node is printed.***
    - ***This print statement is executed after the recursive call, which means it prints the nodes in reverse order as the recursion unwinds back up the call stack.***
-

## ***TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive***

***–Time Complexity .***



### **Best Case (When List is Empty)**

***When List is Empty, then, as soon as it enters the function:***

***TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive, if checks whether head pointer pointed to ``nullptr`` or not , if so then outputs: ``List Is Empty`` and returns nothing , and then exits from function. This takes, constant `c` amount of time i.e.  $\Omega(1)$ .***

***Hence when List is Empty, we get our best case :  $\Omega(1)$ .***

### **Worst Case (When List is not Empty)**

#### **Base Case:**

*When  $T(1)$  i.e. When head will be pointing last node, then  $\text{head} \rightarrow \text{next} = \text{nullptr}$  recursion exits which we say, base case, as pointing last node, recursion exit hence  $T(1) = 1$ .*

#### **Recursion:**

*The recursion occurs  $T(n - 1)$  times i.e. if  $n = 3$  then 2 times as third time  $(* \text{head}) \rightarrow \text{next}$ ; will be ``nullptr``.*

*And, on unwinding of Recursion, each time it prints  $(* \text{head}) \rightarrow \text{data}$  ; .*

*That is forming :  $T(n - 1) + 1$*

*Also, some may say, using Base Case:  $T(n - 1) + T(0)$  , but more precise way is using, printing  $(* \text{head}) \rightarrow \text{data}$  ; on unwinding of recursive stack .*

$$T(n) = \begin{cases} 1 & , \text{for } (n = 1) \\ T(n - 1) + 1 & , \text{for } (n > 1) \end{cases}$$

***A)By Substitution Method:***

$$T(n) = T(n - 1) + 1$$

***Therefore ,*** $T(n - 1) = T(n - 2) + 1$

***Substituting this in  $T(n)$  we get:***

$$T(n) = T(n - 2) + 1 + 1 = T(n - 2) + 2$$

***Now ,*** $T(n - 2) = T(n - 3) + 1$

***Substituting this in  $T(n)$  we get:***

$$T(n) = T(n - 3) + 1 + 2 = T(n - 3) + 3$$

***Now if it runs upto `k` times we get( $k$  levels) :***

***Now ,*** $T(n) = T(n - k) + k$

***We know, base case  $T(1) = 1$  , hence,  $n - k = 1 \Rightarrow k = n - 1$ .***

***When  $k = n$ , we get:***

***Now ,*** $T(n) = T(n - (n - 1)) + (n - 1)$

$$= T(1) + n - 1$$

$$= 1 + n - 1$$

$$= n$$

***Applying ,Big `O` , we get:***

$$= O(n).$$

**B) Recursion Tree Method:**

$$T(n) = \begin{cases} 1 & , \text{for } (n = 1) \\ T(n - 1) + 1 & , \text{for } (n > 1) \end{cases}$$

*or, we can say:*

$$T(n) = \begin{cases} 1 & , \text{for } (n = 1) \\ T(n - 1) + C & , \text{for } (n > 1) \end{cases}$$

***Recalling program:***

```
void TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(Node **head)
{
    if (*head == nullptr)
    {
        cout << "List is empty." << endl;
        return;
    }
    else
    {
        if ((*head)->next != nullptr)
```

```

    {
        TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&((*head)->next));
    }
    cout << (*head)->data << " ";
}
}

```

### **Recursive Call:**

```

TraverseListReverseOrderRecursive(&((*head)->next));

```

runs  $T(N - 1)$  times.

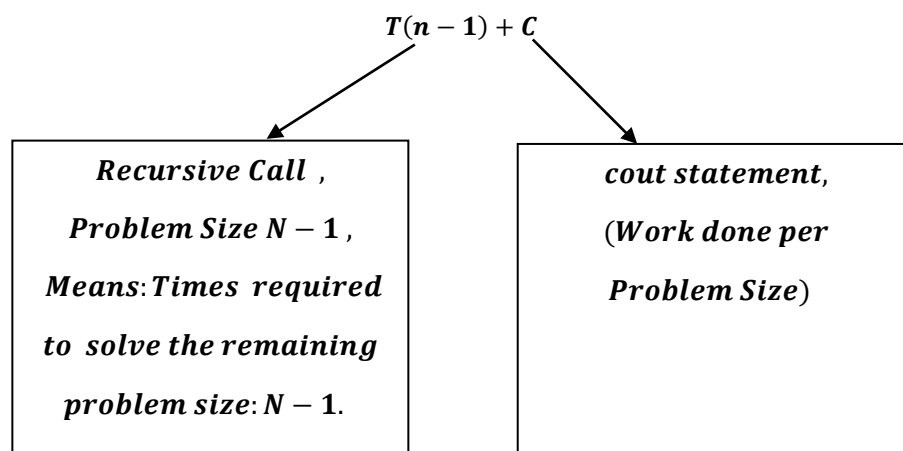
### **Work done per Problem Size:**

```

cout << (*head)->data << " ";

```

This print statement takes 'C', constant amount of time.



| <b>Level</b>                                    | <b>No. of problems</b> | <b>Problem Size</b>       | <b>Work /Cost Per Problem</b><br>(Print<br>'cout'<br>statement) | <b>Work done = Work per Problem × No. of Problems</b>     |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>0</b>                                        | <b>1</b>               | <b><math>n</math></b>     | <b><math>C</math></b>                                           | <b><math>1 \times C = C</math></b>                        |
| <b>1</b>                                        | <b>1</b>               | <b><math>n - 1</math></b> | <b><math>C</math></b>                                           | <b><math>1 \times C = C</math></b>                        |
| <b>2</b>                                        | <b>1</b>               | <b><math>n - 2</math></b> | <b><math>C</math></b>                                           | <b><math>1 \times C = C</math></b>                        |
| <b>.</b>                                        | <b>.</b>               | <b>.</b>                  | <b>.</b>                                                        | <b>.</b>                                                  |
| <b><math>n - 1</math></b><br><b>(Base Case)</b> | <b>1</b>               | <b>1(Base Case)</b>       | <b><math>T(1)</math></b>                                        | <b><math>1 \times T(1)</math><br/><math>= T(1)</math></b> |

**Why level ' $n - 1$ ' is Base Case?**

**Ans : for , level ' $k$ ' :, Base Case =  $T(1) \therefore n - k = 1$   
 $\Rightarrow k = n - 1$ .**

**Total Cost =  $C + C + C + \dots (N - 1)\text{times} + T(1)$ .  
 $= C(N - 1) + T(1)$**

**We know ,  $T(1)$  is 1 instead lets write  $T(1) = C_1$  ,  
representing constant.**

$$= C(N - 1) + C_1$$

**As,  $C$  and  $C_1$  both are constant Applying Big O , we get:**

$$O(N - 1)$$

$$= O(N)$$


---



**Average Case(Average Case = Worst Case)**

*The average case for traversing a linked list typically involves traversing a list of average length. Since the function must visit each node to print its data, the time complexity is  $O(n)$ , where  $(n)$  is the number of nodes in the list.*

---

**Note , by relation:  $\Omega \leq \Theta \leq O$  , we get:**

$$\Rightarrow c_1 \times g(n) \leq f(n) \leq c_2 \times g(n)$$

$$\Rightarrow c_1 \times 1 \leq n \leq c_2 \times n$$

---

| <b><i>Singly Linked List</i></b>                  | <b><i>Cases</i></b>                            | <b><i>Time Complexity</i></b> |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b><i>TraversingListReverseOrderRecursive</i></b> | <b><i>1. Best Case</i></b>                     | <b><math>\Omega(1)</math></b> |
|                                                   | <b><i>2. Worst Case</i></b>                    | <b><math>O(n)</math></b>      |
|                                                   | <b><i>3. Average Case<br/>= Worst Case</i></b> | <b><math>\Theta(n)</math></b> |

\*\*\*\*\*